Ambassador Sreenivasan back to headquarters, after completion of his normal term of duty in Fiji.

India was soaked in election fervour when news of the diplomatic controversy spread like wildfire. The Rajiv Gandhi government, mired in the Bofors scandal, was facing a united opposition led by V.P. Singh. Only two days after the Rajiv Gandhi government made a strong statement against the Rabuka regime, the deposed pro-ethnic Indian leader Timoci Bavadra died in Lautoka, a port city of Fiji. He was only fifty-five. Najma Heptulla, then deputy chairman of the Rajya Sabha, was rushed to Fiji by Gandhi to attend the funeral and to meet Adi Kuini Bavadra, Timoci's widow. She wrote in the condolence book:

Fiji has lost a respected leader on whom the people of Fiji had placed great trust and confidence. He in turn inspired them not only with democratic leadership, but with noble ideals of equality, justice and brotherhood, transcending the narrow barriers of race, colour and religion. For us in India, these values, fundamental as they are to the basic principles of life and governance, bequeathed to us by the father of our nation, Mahatma Gandhi, are of paramount importance. At this moment of national grief for Fiji, the one thought that I would like to express is that there can be no better tribute to the memory of the departed leader than to dedicate

ourselves to the ideals for which he lived and died.

Closely watching the developments in Fiji and India, the band of three decided to fight the tyrannical regime with renewed fury and ruthlessness. Though a large number of supporters had turned up at Bavadra's funeral, creating a louder voice for the reestablishment of democracy, the spies knew Rabuka